

English Ladder

Teaching Guide

Understanding the Usage of "Recommend" and "Suggest"

A concise classroom guide with lesson flow, teaching cues, and a ready-to-use answer key built around the same English Ladder concept sheet.



Grammar Concepts #17

Key Points

Additional Examples

Practice Exercises

Visual anchor

Use the concept poster to spotlight the main language pattern in **Understanding the Usage of "Recommend" and "Suggest"** and keep the explanation visible during practice and discussion.

ENGLISH LADDER

Concept #17 ► **Recommend & Suggest**

The words **'recommend'** and **'suggest'** use a unique verb style. We will first look at the normal style, then at the unique style of these special verbs.

Normal

Most verbs are followed by an object pronoun such as "me", "her", and "them".
The style is of the form "**He** **[verb]** **[object pronoun]** **to** **[action]**."

My boss wants **me to** finish the report soon.
I need **you to** set up a meeting for Friday.
She expected **us to** return to the office by noon.

Unique

However, a small set of verbs use subject pronouns such as "I", "she", and "they".
This set includes: **Suggest | Recommend | Hope | Insist | Prefer | Request**
This style is of the form "**He** **[verb]** **(that)** **[subject pronoun]** **[action]**."

I suggested (that) **they** take a break.
I hope (that) **she** does not burn out from overwork.
He insisted (that) **I** go home since I looked tired.
I prefer (that) **she** give me fewer assignments.
He requested/insisted (that) **we** work remotely.

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At a Glance

Lesson focus Understanding the Usage of "Recommend" and "Suggest"	Suggested timing 45-60 minutes
Core objective Students explain the target pattern clearly and apply it accurately in controlled practice and discussion.	Materials Student PDF, the concept image, board space, and time for partner checking.

Suggested Lesson Flow

Warm-up	Display the concept image and ask learners to predict the rule behind Understanding the Usage of "Recommend" and "Suggest" before reading the explanation.
Model	Walk through the Core Idea and the sections on Key Points, Additional Examples, Practice Exercises. Pause after each part so students can restate the pattern in plain English.
Guided practice	Project two or three examples from the concept sheet and ask pairs to explain why each choice works, not just what the answer is.
Independent work	Assign the 24 practice items for quiet work, partner checking, and final feedback.
Closure	Ask students to create one new sentence or mini-example of their own that follows the same pattern.



Likely Learner Errors

- Learners may overgeneralize the first pattern they notice. Keep returning to **Key Points, Additional Examples, Practice Exercises** and ask students to explain what changes from one example to the next.
- Long explanations can hide the signal word or structure. Have students underline the exact phrase that tells them which form, pattern, or response is needed.
- If students can choose an answer but cannot explain it, ask them to justify their choice using words taken directly from the concept sheet.

Differentiation and Delivery Notes

- Support: teach one section at a time, then send students back to **the examples** or the practice set so they can apply the same rule immediately.
- Pair work: let students compare answers aloud before you reveal the key. The explanation step is as important as the final answer.
- Extension: ask stronger students to write two fresh examples or a short dialogue that uses the same target language accurately.

Model Language from the Concept Sheet

- My boss wants me to finish the report soon. "wants" is the verb, "me" is the object pronoun, and "to finish" is the action.
- I need you to set up a meeting for Friday. "need" is the verb, "you" is the object pronoun, and "to set up" is the action.
- She expected us to return to the office by noon. "expected" is the verb, "us" is the object pronoun, and "to return" is the action.
- I suggested (that) they take a break. "suggested" is the verb, "they" is the subject pronoun, and "take a break" is the action.
- I hope (that) she does not burn out from overwork. "hope" is the verb, "she" is the subject pronoun, and "does not burn out" is the action.
- He insisted (that) I go home since I looked tired. "insisted" is the verb, "I" is the subject pronoun, and "go home" is the action.



Answer Key

Use this key for whole-class feedback or fast marking.

ITEM 01

My boss suggested I take a day off.

ITEM 02

The teacher insisted we be quiet during the lesson.

ITEM 03

It is crucial he finish the project on time.

ITEM 04

They recommended she check the report twice.

ITEM 05

The coach insisted they be more focused during practice.

ITEM 06

It is important I be on time for the meeting.

ITEM 07

The manager asked that he submit the report by Monday.

ITEM 08

She requested that we attend the meeting.

ITEM 09

It is necessary they be informed of any changes.

ITEM 10

The director suggested she review the proposal carefully.

ITEM 11

The lawyer recommended we be cautious with their statements.

ITEM 12

It is vital he understand the rules clearly.

ITEM 13

The instructor demanded she complete the assignment on time.

ITEM 14

It is essential we arrive early tomorrow.

**ITEM 15**

The judge ordered they appear in court.

ITEM 16

The doctor suggested I take a break.

ITEM 17

It is recommended he follow the instructions.

ITEM 18

The principal insisted we be on time.

ITEM 19

The committee suggested they review the policy.

ITEM 20

It is imperative she be prepared.

ITEM 21

The supervisor recommended we attend the training.

ITEM 22

It is crucial they maintain confidentiality.

ITEM 23

The board suggested he approve the budget.

ITEM 24

It is advised we stay calm during emergencies.